REPO RADAR

PhotoCraft: setup guide

What it is: an open-source image editor written in pure Rust. Per its README: layers, masks, adjustment layers, layer styles, type, vectors, brushes and PSD files, in a native app. Status: **early alpha** (README). License: MIT or Apache-2.0.

Link: https://github.com/storytold/photocraft

What we tested

- Cloned the repo into a sandbox (no secrets in the environment).
- Ran `cargo test -p photocraft-psd` (the PSD file crate): **222 unit/integration tests + 1 doctest passed, 0 failed**, about 55 s from a cold clone, compile included.
- We did not test the desktop app itself or the whole workspace.
- Stars: 71,897 on 2026-10-23, about 3 weeks after creation (GitHub API).

Install (from the README)

1. Install Rust: https://rustup.rs
2. `git clone https://github.com/storytold/photocraft && cd photocraft`
3. Run the app: `cargo run --release -p photocraft -- image.psd`
4. Run the tests: `cargo test --workspace`
5. Linux may need system libraries for the UI; check the README.

3 things to try

1. Open a PSD you own and inspect its layer tree.
2. Add a Curves adjustment layer and save in the native `.pcraft` format.
3. Run the tests of one crate (`cargo test -p photocraft-psd`) and read how PSD round trips are checked.

Honest verdict

Impressive engineering and a lot of tests, but the README itself says early alpha: don't replace your main editor yet.

Sources: the repository README and Cargo files; GitHub API data (stars); our own sandbox test run.

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